

5.2b

The style of written English

Worksheet

- E** The language in the text below is informal, spoken English. Rewrite it in a clear, simple, positive style appropriate for a business letter. Keep the basic meaning of the original, but change words and phrases freely.

Hi Sue

I got the letter you sent on 2nd of March. You want the artwork by the 20th? You must be joking! If you want a good job it's going to take at least three weeks. You'll be lucky to get anything from us until early April.

Anyway, you haven't even paid for the last artwork we sent you! We need that money right now. You're not getting anything else until you pay.

All the best

- When you finish, write the same information as an e-mail. This will be similar to the version you have just written, but shorter and more direct.

- F** Repeat the previous activity. Rewrite the text below in a clear, simple, positive style appropriate for a business letter. When you finish, write the same information as an e-mail.

Thanks for your letter – sorry I didn't get in touch until now. Well, about your problem with the machine – it's not our fault. You obviously didn't follow the instructions – that's why it's broken.

You want to claim for it under your guarantee? No way! Don't you remember - you didn't renew your maintenance contract last year.

Anyway, someone from our Service Department will contact you some time to talk about when our engineers are coming.

I'll be here if you want a chat.

- G** Repeat the previous activity. Rewrite the text below in a clear, simple, positive style appropriate for a business letter. When you finish, write the same information as an e-mail.

I got you letter about our Italia kitchen tiles. You want to buy some, right? Great! Just one problem, we haven't got any tiles to send you. The thing is, we're just getting so many orders. Things are going crazy around here, it's just tiles, tiles, tiles.

Look, don't worry. I'll get in touch as soon as we get some more. I'm sure it won't be long.

Meanwhile, I'm gonna send you our latest brochure – you'll love it. It's full of great photos and you can see everything we sell.

Give me a call if you want to. Bye.

